

THE STUDY · PREPRINT · UNDER REVIEW

Does ten minutes of daily meditation ease anxiety? A fully remote randomized trial of an ultra-brief digital meditation program



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299

ADULTS · RANDOMIZED TRIAL

10_{min/day}

FOR 8 WEEKS

Ten minutes of SOS meditation a day reduced *anxiety* and *mind-wandering* – and the gains *lasted*.



WHO 299 adults, meditation-naïve

US adults (mean age 34) with no prior meditation experience. Randomized into two arms in a fully remote trial.



WHAT 10 minutes a day, 8 weeks

After brief instructor training, participants practiced SOS meditation on their own at home – silently, eyes closed, for ~10 minutes daily.



WE FOUND Less anxious, more focused

Anxiety (GAD-7) and mind-wandering both dropped during the meditation phase. The pattern replicated in the waitlist arm later when they started practicing.



WHAT STUCK The gains held at follow-up

Eight weeks after participants stopped daily practice, the improvements were still there. People who started most anxious benefited the most.

HOW THE TRIAL WORKED

A waitlist-controlled, two-phase design

— ARM 1 — MEDITATES WEEKS 0-8 — ARM 2 — WAITLIST, THEN MEDITATES WEEKS 8-16 — RANDOMIZED PHASE

Anxiety ↓

GAD-7 · LOWER IS BETTER



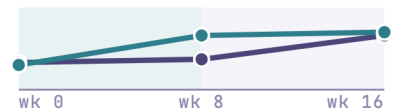
Mind wandering ↓

MWQ · LOWER IS BETTER



Social connectedness ↑

SELF-REPORT · HIGHER IS BETTER



• **The same pattern across outcomes:** each measure moved while an arm was meditating, held through follow-up, and repeated when Arm 2 began – an internal replication. Schematic; direction of effect only.

BEYOND ANXIETY A multimodal battery – many other outcomes also moved.

✓ IMPROVED ACROSS THE SAMPLE:

Mind wandering Perceived stress Rumination Depressive symptoms Social connectedness Quality of life

ⓘ IMPROVED SELECTIVELY: Sleep (poor baseline sleepers) · Cognitive tasks (lower-performing participants) · Resting heart rate (small reductions)

→ People who started with moderate or severe anxiety showed the largest improvements – the pattern held across most outcomes.

HOW TO READ THIS

Preprint posted April 2026; not yet peer-reviewed. RCT in a non-clinical, US-recruited sample (mean age 34, 67% female). Findings may not generalize to all populations. Statistical effects reported with FDR correction in the paper.

PREPRINT

Glick CC, Pirzada S, Quah S, et al. (2026). A fully remote randomized controlled trial of an ultra-brief digital meditation intervention reduces internalizing symptoms. *medRxiv* doi:10.64898/2026.04.19.26351219 · NCT06014281 · not yet peer-reviewed.



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